SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #57 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

“I can never be safe.”

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Where it often comes from

Trauma, accidents, crime, illness, or frightening events can convince the mind that danger is everywhere. The body stays on alert, and the world feels like a minefield. We may avoid places, people, and activities to stay safe.

What Scripture teaches

“He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty,” and the psalmist calls the LORD his refuge and fortress. “I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety.” “When you pass through the waters, I will be with you.” “The LORD will guard you from all evil; He will preserve your soul.” Scripture does not promise a life with no harm, but it promises God’s presence and ultimate safety in Him.

> *“He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, ‘You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.’”* (Psalm 91:1–2).

Also see

> “I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety” (Psalm 4:8).

> “When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze” (Isaiah 43:2).

> “The LORD will guard you from all evil; He will preserve your soul. The LORD will watch over your coming and going, both now and forevermore” (Psalm 121:7–8).

> “God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas” (Psalm 46:1–2).

Common self-statements

- Danger is everywhere.
- Something bad will happen.
- I cannot relax.
- Nowhere is safe.
- I cannot protect myself or my family.
- I have to watch constantly.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing things are either perfectly safe or dangerous.
- Mind reading: Assuming danger is likely.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that I am in danger.
- Fortune telling: Predicting harm.

Challenging questions

- What happened that taught me danger is everywhere?
- What is the actual likelihood of what I fear?
- Where do I feel safe, even a little?
- What does Scripture say about God's presence in danger?
- What would help my body calm down?
- Who could help me, such as a counselor?

Truth summary

> I live in a world with real risks, but I am not alone. God is my refuge, and I can take wise precautions without living on alert. Healing from trauma is possible with support.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Peace
- Sleep Problems
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can never be safe"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can never be safe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What taught me this?
- ☐ How likely is it?
- ☐ Where do I feel safe?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What calms my body?
- ☐ Who can help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is my refuge and fortress.
- ☐ I can lie down and sleep in peace.
- ☐ God is with me through the waters.
- ☐ He guards my coming and going.
- ☐ Wise caution is enough.
- ☐ Healing is possible.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 91:1–2**
  "He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, 'You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.'"
- ☐ **Psalm 4:8**
  "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety."
- ☐ **Isaiah 43:2**
  "When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Safe in His presence: Each day, note one moment you felt safe and thank God.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 4:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord alone makes me dwell in safety.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name triggers. Write what sets off the alarm.
- ☐ Practice calming. Breathe slowly and ground yourself.
- ☐ Pray Psalm 4:8. Say it at bedtime.
- ☐ Get support. If trauma is behind this, talk with a counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can never be safe": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Safe in His presence
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can never be safe.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my body stays on guard. Be my refuge and my fortress. Teach me to rest in Your presence and to take wise steps without living in fear. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.